War. As a consequence, India became gradually more dependent on military supplies from the Soviet Union, paving the way for a major agreement in 1971. The logic of the Cold War nonetheless continued to impose itself upon India in some curious ways. One incident during this period was the defection from the Soviet Union of Svetlana Alliluyeva, the daughter of its former leader Joseph Stalin (later known as Lana Peters). After becoming romantically involved with an Indian communist, Alliluyeva travelled to India. In early 1967, she approached the US Embassy in New Delhi, seeking asylum in the United States. Her defection put India in an awkward position, as it continued to balance its relationships with both the eastern and western blocs. [125]

Perhaps the greatest economic development of the 1960s for India was the Green Revolution. In 1965, high yield varieties of wheat, combined with fertilizer and irrigation techniques, were introduced into India after successful results in Mexico. The initiative was spearheaded by the American scientist Norman Borlaug and benefited from private American financial assistance and the political and technocratic leadership of C. Subramaniam in India. It had an almost immediate effect on Indian crop yields. While the United States had started to aggressively use food aid as a diplomatic lever, the Green Revolution helped to make India self-sufficient in grains. [126] It remains a potent example of how India's international partnerships, if leveraged correctly, can actually facilitate independence and autonomy.

But despite these developments, the vacuum created by Nehru's death in 1964 and that of his successor Shastri in early 1966, led to international affairs generally assuming a lower priority for New Delhi. By the early 1970s, this began to change with Indira Gandhi's consolidation of power. The split of the Congress Party, her concentration of executive power, and the nationalization of important sectors of the economy heralded the political shift. [127] Then, just nine years after its greatest military humiliation in 1962, independent India experienced perhaps its greatest military victory in Bangladesh.